

Michael Venuto (Tidal) sur la mécanique de NANC et GOP

The Meb Faber Show, épisode #560, « Michael Venuto on ETFs in 2024 », publié le 06/12/2024.
Transcription officielle — chapitre « Congressional trading insights », **42:01 à 45:47, en entier**.
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Chapitre « *Congressional trading insights* », **42:01 → 45:47**, reproduit **intégralement**.
Meb Faber interroge Michael Venuto (CIO et co-fondateur de Tidal) sur NANC et KRUZ (aujourd'hui GOP).

L'ouverture du chapitre

Meb Faber — 42:18

So you have some funds I put in the innovative fund category too, Nancy and what's the other one? Cruz?

Michael Venuto — 42:26

Cruz, k r u z.

Meb Faber — 42:28

Hard to remember even your own tickers at this point. I was joking before and we'll have to put this in the show notes. One of my single favorite social media videos is I have a couple posts. Like, **the fact that sitting congressmen can trade stocks is probably the most universally held belief across individual citizens as being absolutely crazy and corrupt**. Like, why in God's name should they be able to trade stocks with their inside information?

Meb Faber — 42:56

It's nuts. And there's a video of Dave Chappelle, comedian, and then it overlays it with Pelosi where she's talked someone asked her about trading stocks, and she's like, what? I can't hear you, and just, like, leaves the conference room. [...]

La mécanique : d'où vient la donnée, et qui décide

Meb Faber — 43:14

Talk to us about these funds. What are they doing?

Michael Venuto — 43:16

So the client here is a company called Subversive, and they partnered with Unusual Whales to partial out the data. So **the data is public disclosure. Anybody can**

go get it. The problem is it looks like gobbledygook. It's not like they're putting a lot of effort into making this usable data.

Michael Venuto — 43:33

So Unusual Whales helps out with, you know, really partialling through the data. Then that data is sent over to Tidal. **We have also as a service here active portfolio managers.** So Dan Weiskopf spends a lot of time **poking through the data to try and find the patterns.** And patterns are things where we know there was a **committee hearing** or we know that **multiple people did it at once.**

Michael Venuto — 43:54

Or, like, for example, no Republican had reported buying Tesla until Marjorie Taylor Greene did it the day before the election. So things like that we look for. And then the portfolio is essentially because they're required to disclose this information, if they use inside information, it's not that they have to say they used it. They just have to tell us that they did something, right, that they traded.

Michael Venuto — 44:21

And that's it. Now **some of them have a broker who's just doing some direct indexing** for them. We have to weed through that noise in the data. When we see **300 trades** and they were all, like, this big, 5 shares of something, we know that's **just a rebalance.** Right?

La thèse du fonds, et la qualité de la donnée d'entrée

Michael Venuto — 44:37

So it's all about getting down to the nitty gritty of what they're actually doing. And, **hopefully, we capture some of that alpha that they're legally allowed to do,** and you and I as fiduciaries in a regulated asset management firm would never even think of doing. But if we did, we'd go to jail. [...] Martha Stewart went to jail for what Nancy Pelosi and Marjorie Taylor Greene are allowed to do legally.

Michael Venuto — 45:03

And **if they don't report what they did, the fine is, like, \$250.**

Michael Venuto — 45:13

I think at some point, they're gonna make the fine bigger or the timing preapproval or something like that, but they're never gonna change this rule. **They might make it better, which will give us better data to make better decisions** from, but the STOCK Act is not gonna go away.

Ce que ce chapitre établit

- la source de données est **la déclaration publique** — Unusual Whales ne fait que la rendre exploitable ;

- la sélection est **discrétionnaire** : un gérant cherche des motifs (auditions en commission, achats simultanés, premier acheteur d'un camp) ; les gérants actifs sont un **service de la plateforme**, pas une équipe dédiée au fonds ;
- le fonds **écarte le bruit** des comptes gérés en *direct indexing* : les dépôts massifs de micro-opérations sont identifiés comme de simples rebalancements et ignorés ;
- **la thèse assumée du fonds est qu'il existe un alpha à capter** — c'est exactement l'hypothèse que teste la §5(c) ;
- **l'amende pour non-déclaration est de l'ordre de 250 \\$** : la donnée d'entrée est donc incomplète par construction, et le gérant le dit lui-même — une meilleure loi donnerait « *better data to make better decisions from* ».

Contexte (même épisode, 1:37) : Tidal est une plateforme de « *white label* » ETF — **plus de 175 ETF, plus de 25 milliards de dollars**. NANC et GOP sont deux fonds parmi ces 175. Hors de ce chapitre, l'épisode porte sur l'industrie ETF (conversions 351, fiscalité du wrapper, communauté FIRE) et ne dit rien de plus sur NANC/GOP.